



The Sony Cyber-Shot P73

pay for in terms of image quality.

In terms of features, the Orite VC-R500 and VC-5000Z were quite decent, with good image quality. The Kodak CX7220 was the only camera that managed an ideal balance of price and performance.

This camera returned average results in most tests. It has features such as 2.1X optical zoom and 16 MB inbuilt memory. It sells for just Rs 9,500.

The Casio Ex-Z30 is very compact, but the combination of low storage and high price makes it more of a flaunt-value gadget than a daily-use camera.

Olympus, with its two models, failed to make any

mark despite its low price and decent features. It lost out on performance.

The Nikon Coolpix 4100, which won the Silver in our tests, came up with some excellent images, and it is very handy as well. It is perfect when it comes to ergonomics. The price is slightly on the higher side, but given the performance, it is worth it.

The winner, the Sony P73, returned good overall results. It runs on rechargeable Ni-MH batteries, and has a 16 MB Memory-

Stick. It is definitely a very sturdy camera. The menu navigation is the easiest to handle. It has pre-defined modes such as Night and Landscape. Given all that, at Rs 18,990, it is a good investment.

LESS THAN Rs 30,000 Features Galore!

When you are eyeing a camera that costs over Rs 20,000, you would obviously expect a lot of features. Indeed, features were brimming in this category. Some cameras however, did manage to surprise by offering quite a lot of features.

The DX6490 was a surprise entrant; it was akin to an SLR. The Canon A80 also featured with good optics, especially its tilting LCD screen which alleviates the twisting and contortions associated with shooting at odd angles. Ten cameras from five different brands made it to this category. There were two models each from Canon,

Samsung and Sony, while Kodak had three and HP just one. The Kodak DX6490 was the costliest contender at Rs, 31,900, because of the 10x optical zoom lens.



The Nikon Coolpix 4100

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